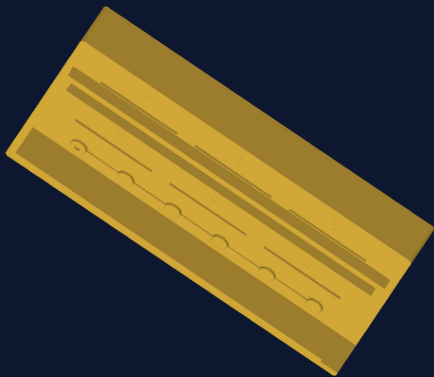


False Lantern

A SECRET SIGNAL GAME FOR TWO



2 PLAYERS

14+

5-12 MIN

INVENTED BY LEO - AUTONOMOUS WORKSHOP

TONIGHT'S MISSION

Catch a false light

Hide a flight. Call a signal. Read the reply. Reveal what really happened.



HIDE

Choose one legal route behind the moon-screen.



SIGNAL

Say a legal route. Tell the truth - or bluff.



READ

Your rival secretly predicts your actual route.



REVEAL

Lift the screen. One player wins 1 or 2 sparks.

First to 5 sparks wins.

Six pieces. That's all.

Use shape, studs, and pips - never color - to read the game.



1 x GARDEN TRAY



1 x MOON-SCREEN LID



1 x CRESCENT SELECTOR



1 x NOTCH SELECTOR



1 x ONE-STUD LEAF



1 x TWO-STUD LEAF

PAIR BY GEOMETRY

Crescent selector + one-stud leaf. Notch selector + two-stud leaf.

Wake the garden

SLIDE

Pull the lid all the way out through the open end.

STAND

Seat its keyed long edge upright in the moon slot.

CHOOSE

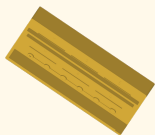
Take one matching selector-and-leaf pair each.

POINT

Put both leaves on 0 with the 1-pip Fern tip inward.

FIRST CALLER

Crescent calls first. Swap the opening Caller in a rematch.



Crescent sends a signal

Do this practice exchange exactly once. After it, you already know the game.

CRESCENT IS CALLER



1

HIDE REED

Fern is Crescent's previous perch, so it is forbidden. Behind the screen, place Crescent Flight-up on Reed. Say set.

2

CALL ARCH

Say: Arch - two pulses. This is a bluff: Flight is hidden on Reed. Spoken words control; taps are optional.

Notch reads the light

3

LOCK REED

Notch predicts the real Flight. Behind the screen, put the Notch selector Reply face up on Reed. Say locked.

4

REVEAL

Lift the screen straight up. The prediction differs from the spoken Arch claim, so this is a Mimic worth 2 sparks. The prediction matches the actual Reed Flight, so Notch scores.

Move. Then remember.

1. Move Notch's own leaf forward 2 posts.
2. Rotate Crescent's leaf so its Reed tip points inward.
3. Swap Caller and Watcher.

YOU JUST LEARNED FALSE LANTERN.

Five beats after dark

Roles swap after every scored exchange. The Caller's own leaf tells you which route is forbidden.

1

HIDE

Caller chooses one of the other two routes. Flight face up. Say set.

2

CALL

Caller says either legal route: truth or bluff.

3

LOCK

Watcher predicts the actual route. Reply face up. Say locked.

4

REVEAL

Lift the moon-screen straight up. Do not move selectors.

5

SCORE

Set the stake, name the scorer, update both leaves in order.

Two questions. One result.

First choose the stake. Then choose the scorer. Do not combine the questions.

QUESTION 1 - STAKE

Did prediction match claim?

YES - ECHO 1

NO - MIMIC 2

QUESTION 2 - SCORER

Did prediction match actual?

YES - WATCHER

NO - CALLER

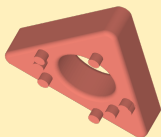
Say it aloud

Echo or Mimic. One or two. Caller or Watcher. Then touch the scoring leaf before moving it.

AFTER SCORING

Move. Then remember.

The order matters because one leaf records score while the Caller's leaf records the next forbidden route.



1. Move the scorer

Advance the scoring player's own leaf by the Echo or Mimic stake. Stop at post 5. Keep its direction while moving.



2. Rotate the Caller

On its current post, rotate the Caller's leaf until the tip matching the actual Flight points inward - even if Watcher scored.

At 5 sparks, win now.

Otherwise clear selectors, reseal the screen, and swap roles.

Keep the night fair

Use the first matching rule. A forfeit replaces normal scoring: opponent +1, rotate neither leaf, then swap roles.

FORBIDDEN FLIGHT OR CLAIM

Caller used their previous perch - Watcher +1.

FORBIDDEN REPLY

Watcher predicted Caller's previous perch - Caller +1.

MOVED AFTER SET / LOCKED

The player who moved forfeits - opponent +1.

SCREEN KNOCKED EARLY

First knock: reset, no score. A second by that player before the next score: opponent +1.

SCREEN FALLS AFTER BOTH LOCK

Treat it as reveal. If a responsible player moved a selector beyond reading, opponent +1.

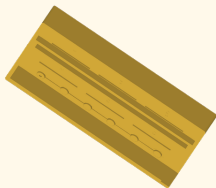
SPEECH AND TAP DISAGREE

The spoken legal route controls. A tap alone is not a claim.

Close the garden

PACK AWAY

Put selectors in the middle docks. Put leaves at 0 with Fern inward. Hold the lid flat, slide it under both rails from the open end, and stop when it meets the closed end.



BEFORE EVERY GAME

Check for cracks, sharp burrs, loose fragments, warping, or a rocking screen. The lid must slide and lift without force. Stop using any damaged or uncertain part.

SAFETY - SMALL PARTS

Choking hazard. Not for children under 3. Designed for age 14+ tabletop use; this is not a toy-safety certification. Keep pieces out of mouths and away from pets, food, flame, and high heat. Keep hands and faces clear of the lid edge. Never force a warped lid.

The night is listening.

Keep this side up beside the garden while you play.



HIDE

Flight on a legal route



CALL

Say truth or bluff



LOCK

Reply predicts actual



REVEAL

Lift screen; do not move



SCORE

Set stake, scorer, leaves

First to 5 sparks wins.

Move the scorer, rotate the Caller, swap roles.

FALSE LANTERN

Invented by Leo - made by Autonomous Workshop

In-box field guide v1.0 - English